Part 5 — Venkata Josyula — STAR answer bank (product + behavioral, bar-raiser style)

Friday Oct 30, 12:00 PM PDT · Principal PM, FBA · the last interview of the loop · Amazon L6 Senior Supply Chain Manager, NACF

Rajesh Rishiyur Chandrasekaran · every answer is STAR, first person, with the number to land, what not to say, the source story and the likely follow-up. Product / customer angle only — Rocky got program and cutover, James got process and governance.

Contents

A · How to run this hour (cram) and the ten stories, three levels deep

B · STAR answer bank — 16 LPs × 2 real AIQB questions = 32 answers

C · NEW — six behavioral questions not used with Tripathy, Hoerger, or Rocky's six NEW

D · Router — 16 Leadership Principles to story ids, one page

E · Bar-raiser trap drills — four sentences

A · How to run this hour

Who he is. Principal PM in FBA, so he thinks about the seller as a customer, inbound trust, and mechanisms that scale. He is the bar raiser, so he will dig three levels into one story, separate *I* from *we*, and ask what failed. **My frame for him:** "I treat supply-chain programs as products: a named customer, a written problem, a ranked requirement list with a visible deferral list, a metric chosen before launch, and a gate held in public."

THREE OPENING SENTENCES (PICK ONE WHEN HE SAYS "TELL ME ABOUT YOURSELF")

- "I build the systems that decide what we can promise a customer — order allocation at Manhattan, visibility at Flexport, inventory and warehouse programs at Sephora — and I run them like products: customer, metric, gate."
- "The pattern in my work is that the customer was being promised from the wrong place, and my job was to make one true promise and prove it with a number we agreed before launch."
- "I am happiest when the deferral list is written down, the launch gate is published before the wave, and the review makes the decision instead of me."

THE FIVE NUMBERS NEVER TO GET WRONG

- **Shipment Visibility:** 7 to 68 customers, 9.7 times; cost to serve $0.66 to $0.03 per container, about 95%. Never round to ten times. record
- **Manhattan discrepancy:** about 200 orders, $2.5M of *order value*; the $10M is the *initiative won*, not savings. record
- **Snowflake pipeline:** four systems to one; WBR accuracy 60% to 90%; the status quo was *priced* at over $100K a year, not saved. record
- **EDI lanes:** a thousand lanes were asked; 597 carrying 80% of spend went first; completeness 60% to 95%. record
- **LLM triage:** $25 to $0.40 per incident, 98%, independent build — not an employer deployment. record

Freshness. The hiring manager heard Shipment Visibility from the operating lens and the Flexport FF App roadmap / cost-to-serve story; Ryan was routed through S9 among others. With Venkata, Shipment Visibility is told as a *product* (graduation criteria, the customer it protected, the flattering number thrown away), S12 only as the rebuild-or-reuse rule and partner adoption, and S9 only as the customer conversation and the small-carrier floor. If he says "I think you told my colleague this," say: "You may have heard the program; I'll give you the product decision inside it, which they didn't get."

The ten stories — the 20-second version, the trade-off, the failure line, three levels deep

Use each card when he digs. Level 1 is what I did; level 2 is how I knew; level 3 is what I would change or what proves it. Basis labels: **record** = Apple v11 / resume / master packet; **record-from-docs** = a page of a program document.

V1 · S11 — Flexport Shipment Visibility as a product: 7 → 68 customers behind six published graduation criteria

LPs Customer Obsession · Deliver Results · Earn Trust · Insist on the Highest Standards

20-second version. Leadership told me the visibility program was not showing value. I was program owner across nine teams and about a hundred people. I published six graduation criteria to Sales before wave one, held wave three in public on an ETA-accuracy miss from one bad source, and threw away a flattering 99.4% week. We went from 7 to 68 customers with zero rollbacks, and cost to serve fell from $0.66 to $0.03 per container.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Sales wanted the whole pool boarded at once. I chose waves behind criteria, which cost us speed in the first two quarters; the VP still unlocked the 68-customer rollout two months early.

Failure / learning. I started the weekly review after the critique, not at kickoff. Next time the review starts on day one.

Three levels deep. L1: I wrote the seven metric definitions and the six graduation criteria. L2: the owner of each input — Data Services, Support, GTM — signed the definition they would be red against; a 300-container sample gave ±1.6% at 95% confidence. L3: what proves it held is that the customers we held in wave three became the cleanest wave.

SAFE-SAY. “Seven to sixty-eight customers is 9.7 times, and cost to serve per container went from sixty-six cents to three cents — about ninety-five percent.” **Source?** “The State of SV and pilot roll-out documents, and the master packet's launch record.”

V2 · Crux customer transition — 79 customers, a segment rule each, honest cancels

LPs Customer Obsession · Earn Trust · Are Right, A Lot · Have Backbone

20-second version. Flexport had acquired a visibility product, Crux, with 79 customers — $185,892 of ARR and 294,581 containers in 2021 — and the aim was to move them to Shipment Visibility by end 2022. Not every segment fit. The decision gave each segment a rule: shippers to Shipment Visibility, forwarders, customs brokers and 3PLs to the SV API with no extra dev, two brokers to a partner product, and the two competitor SaaS accounts cancelled on published dates.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Building parity features for small segments versus a clean path or a clean cancel. The decision chose no extra build; the cost was some revenue and some goodwill in the long tail.

Failure / learning. The dissent in the document asked for the cost of keeping Crux running; that number should have been in the first draft, not requested by a reviewer.

Three levels deep. L1: the segment table — GKA 2, Enterprise 14, SMB 39 to SV. L2: the two brokers carried most of the volume, so they got individual calls; one relationship mattered because of a 600-truck drayage partner. L3: cancels dated August 1 and October 24, 2022 are the proof that the hard part was done, not deferred.

SAFE-SAY. “Seventy-nine customers, about $186 thousand of ARR — I do not claim any preserved-ARR number, because the document doesn't have one.” **Source?** “The RAPID decision document for the Crux customer transition, the 2022 version.”

V3 · S14 — Manhattan: the $2.5M OMS↔WMS discrepancy my manager wanted fixed quietly

LPs Earn Trust · Have Backbone · Customer Obsession · Bias for Action

20-second version. Two days before an executive review, OMS and WMS did not reconcile — about 200 orders, $2.5M of order value — and a $10M initiative rode on the review. My manager and the room favored a quiet back-end fix. I built the discrepancy census by cause, argued risk not virtue, offered to run the war room myself, and we told the customer first. The prioritized orders were patched line by line, and the initiative was won.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Quiet script versus transparency. I chose transparency and put the cost — my time in a war room, my risk of being wrong in front of the customer — on myself.

Failure / learning. I should have proposed the standing reconciliation report before there was a crisis to justify it.

Three levels deep. L1: the census by cause and the options memo were mine; the consultants traced the handshake and wrote the patch. L2: a cross-table script written in two days had no rollback; per-line patching did. L3: the standing reason-coded reconciliation report, read before every executive review, is what outlived the war room.

SAFE-SAY. “The $2.5 million is order value in discrepancy; the $10 million is the initiative the customer awarded — I don't count it as savings.” **Source?** “My Manhattan consulting record, as captured in the master packet.”

V4 · S16 — Flexport: four systems into one Snowflake pipeline

LPs Ownership · Invent and Simplify · Frugality · Learn and Be Curious

20-second version. Our Monday review ran on four systems stitched together in Google Sheets by one person — me. Accuracy was 60%, tickets had no container ID, and a VP was steering on a number I could break. I wrote the BRD, priced the status quo at over $100K a year in the infra team's own rates, and held cutover to a parallel run within 1% for consecutive weeks. Accuracy went to 90%, and the first automated catch was a 4% ticket-sync drop nobody could see before.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Build the pipeline before or after the rollout. I kept the manual pull running every Monday as the rollback rather than pause the review.

Failure / learning. I did not plan the data-access security review and it cost two weeks; I owned it upward the same day. (That miss is James's failure story — mention it in one line only.)

Three levels deep. L1: I wrote the BRD and owned cutover; infra built it. L2: the join gap — tickets without a container ID — was solved with a cross-reference table first, then a real key pushed upstream. L3: bus factor went from one to at least two, and the definitions now live in code.

SAFE-SAY. “The hundred thousand is a priced baseline in the infra team's own rates — it is not a savings claim.” **Source?** “The BRD for SV Zendesk data in Snowflake and the master packet's S16 record.”

V5 · S9 — Elementum: a thousand lanes asked, 597 built first

LPs Have Backbone · Customer Obsession · Insist on the Highest Standards · Success and Scale

20-second version. The customer's Global Head of Supply Chain wanted inbound visibility on a thousand lanes in two months; data completeness was 60% and the high-value lanes were blind. I built the spend Pareto — 597 lanes carried 80% of freight spend — pre-validated it with Transportation and Procurement, and took it two levels above my sponsor. I published a 95% valid-ASN gate and held a cohort twice when it failed on a timestamp format. Completeness reached 95%.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. All thousand lanes at once versus spend-weighted cohorts. I chose cohorts and an XML/portal floor so small carriers could stay in the standard; the cost was telling an executive no on lane count.

Failure / learning. Automating dirty data manufactures confident wrong answers; I would publish the gate even earlier, in the kickoff deck.

Three levels deep. L1: I owned the scope analysis and the onboarding standard; engineers built the maps. L2: the lane score was spend × criticality × mode × volume, and no lane owner could contradict the cut. L3: freight spend fell about 10%, roughly $2M in six months, and about 200 lanes followed behind the same gate.

SAFE-SAY. “A thousand lanes were asked; 597 carrying 80% of spend went first — that is spend share, not lane count.” **Source?** “The Elementum program record in the master packet, S9.”

V6 · S13 — Manhattan: Cyber Monday, 4 AM, the scheduler that died

LPs Bias for Action · Customer Obsession · Deliver Results · Dive Deep

20-second version. I was the OMS consultant on allocation and promising for a retailer with 3 DCs and 100 stores. At 4 AM on Cyber Monday the VP called: backorders piling up with inventory present, about $6M of sales at risk against a 95% fill goal. I ranked clears by promise at risk instead of first-in-first-out, rebalanced so no DC drowned, and logged every move. The root cause was an allocation scheduler that died silently at the daylight-saving change. We delivered 99% fill and protected about $8M of peak sales.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Act before knowing the cause, or wait. I acted, with every rebalance reversible and timestamped.

Failure / learning. Nobody had written a clearing rule for failure — including me. Now the rule is written before the peak.

Three levels deep. L1: I owned the response and the post-mortem mechanisms; engineering fixed the scheduler once I isolated it. L2: the contradiction — available to promise above zero while backorders rose — was my evidence to declare an incident. L3: the heartbeat, DST checklist, 3σ page rule and rehearsed rebalance playbook meant the next peak ran boring.

SAFE-SAY. “About eight million of peak sales protected against about six million at risk — both are the record; any margin figure is my model.” **Source?** “My Manhattan consulting record in the master packet, S13.”

V7 · I1 — independent LLM triage agent: eval first, no citation no proposal

LPs Invent and Simplify · Frugality · Learn and Be Curious · Dive Deep

20-second version. I built an independent LLM triage agent for operational incident queues and treated it as a product, not a demo. The naive version cost $25 per incident and could answer without evidence. I graded historical incidents into an eval set, made it the release gate, required every proposal to cite the ticket and runbook, and routed easy classes to smaller models. Cost fell to $0.40 per incident, 98%, with 100% citation coverage and accuracy held on the eval set.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. One expensive model for everything versus tiered routing. I chose routing, which added complexity and eval maintenance.

Failure / learning. The early eval set grew while I was judging prompts; I would freeze and version the baseline before the first change.

Three levels deep. L1: I built the stack, the eval harness and the operating rule myself. L2: cost by class showed most incidents were easy; small models held on those against the eval set. L3: at FBA scale, access review, data boundaries and drift become programs of their own; I'd keep a human approval gate until production evidence beats the human baseline.

SAFE-SAY. “This was my independent build, not an employer production program.” **Source?** “My build records, captured in the Apple workbook, I1.”

V8 · G1 — Elementum: the UAT that crashed two days before sign-off (my failure)

LPs Are Right, A Lot · Earn Trust · Ownership · Insist on the Highest Standards

20-second version. Two days before UAT sign-off on an Elementum track-and-trace app, five key users had passed all ten end-to-end scenarios. Then the sponsor opened access broadly and concurrent logins crashed the system. My first move made it worse: I reran my scenarios and sent screenshots. I owned the miss to the sponsor, engineering simulated concurrency and fixed it, and I rewrote the UAT contract with numeric load criteria. The sign-off date was missed.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Hold the sign-off date with a waiver, or miss it honestly. I chose to miss it rather than ask the customer to accept an unproven system.

Failure / learning. My failure was defensive diagnosis — I mistook my coverage for the truth. The first hour of an escalation now goes to reproducing the customer's shape.

Three levels deep. L1: I owned readiness and the criteria. L2: the requirement was implicit — users worked the way their job demanded. L3: the proof the lesson stuck is that my later Flexport launch gate was written in load terms before customer testing.

SAFE-SAY. “Five key users passed ten scenarios, but concurrent access crashed the system two days before sign-off; my criteria omitted load, and the deadline was missed.” **Source?** “Apple workbook G1, pages 43–44.”

V9 · UDC-B4 — Sephora: one promise per customer, in both countries (product lens)

LPs Customer Obsession · Invent and Simplify · Learn and Be Curious · Success and Scale

20-second version. In Utah a store and a dotcom shopper could want the same unit in the same building and get two different answers, because the building kept two books. I treated it as product work: one pool with two selling identities, the requirements ranked so the go-live set was the minimum that made one promise true, and a written list of what we would not build. Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents. For Canada, the plan reused an existing cross-dock path, twenty small brands first.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Fewer features sooner with the deferrals written down — no history conversion, no reserve-math change. The cost landed on analysts, who lived with two systems of record for four months.

Failure / learning. The analyst was a customer I under-served; the interim reporting got a workstream in month three instead of day one.

Three levels deep. L1: I owned the requirement set and the customer outcome. L2: the issues log's own categories — 331 go-live, 77 fast-follow, 36 enhancement — are the record of the triage. L3: 85.4% of 836 issues closed and the rest owned; processing efficiency up 15% by DC Ops' measurement.

SAFE-SAY. “Thirteen percent is the Canada discovery deck's figure for US-managed store volume — the plan at discovery exit, not a measured outcome.” **Source?** “The July 2024 architecture-council deck, the June 2023 Canada discovery deck, and the program issues log.”

V10 · S12 (product-decision facet only) — Flexport FF App: the rebuild-or-reuse rule and partner adoption

LPs Think Big · Frugality · Customer Obsession

20-second version. The hiring manager heard this roadmap. For Venkata, tell only the product decision inside it: I wrote a per-module rule — anything over eight dev-weeks to rebuild gets reused — and chose partners as the first persona. The MVP went live with 11 partners in 10 countries, and 48 of 53 import partners migrated within a month. Operators stayed on old screens two more quarters, and we priced and published that cost.

TRADE-OFF I MADE. Partner-first versus operator-first. I chose partners, knowingly leaving operators on old screens for two more quarters.

Failure / learning. I would have written the reversal trigger into the first draft rather than the second.

Three levels deep. L1: I owned the sequencing recommendation; engineering re-estimated. L2: 20% of the work was still happening in the old app, which made reuse the cheaper path. L3: about $5M of cost avoidance is the record figure — I say it once.

SAFE-SAY. “About five million of cost avoidance — said once, never as an annual run-rate too.” **Source?** “The FF App high-level solution documents and the master packet S12.”

B · STAR answer bank — 16 LPs × 2 real AIQB questions

Each answer runs about 90 seconds aloud. Say the opener, then S, T, A, R in that order, then stop. Answers whose AIQB wording the hiring manager also used are marked in the note line; the story here is different, so it stays fresh.

B1 · Customer Obsession AIQB: Customer Obsession Q1 · story V3 · S14

"Describe a difficult interaction you had with a customer. How did you deal with it? What was the outcome? How would you handle it differently?"

Opener: "The hardest customer conversation I've had was one my own side didn't want to have — telling a customer, two days before their executive review, that our two systems disagreed about $2.5 million of their orders."

S I was a consultant at a Manhattan customer. Two days before an executive review, OMS and WMS did not reconcile — about 200 orders, $2.5M of order value — and a $10M initiative rode on that review. My manager and the room favored a quiet back-end correction.

T I owned the recommendation and, once we chose, the war room.

A I built a discrepancy census by cause on a sample of the 200 so we argued facts first. I told my manager privately, then disagreed on risk: a cross-table script written in two days had no rollback, and an IT audit would turn a data issue into a trust issue. I offered to run the war room myself. I wrote the customer pack — root cause, plan, timeline, no apology-first — and sent it to their IT and finance before the review, not in it. They chose which orders mattered most; we patched those line by line with before-and-after evidence per order.

R The prioritized set reconciled to zero before the review, the handshake got a clean root-cause fix, and the customer awarded the $10M initiative. The reconciliation report became a standing control. Differently: I would have proposed that report before there was a crisis to justify it.

Number to land: about 200 orders, $2.5M of order value; $10M initiative won record · **Do not say:** "we saved $10M" — it is an initiative won, not savings; "the customer was angry" — they were not; they prioritized and gave us time
Likely follow-up: "What if your manager had said no?" — I would have written up the risk assessment and asked for the decision to be recorded with its owner, then committed — with the tripwire named: any audit query on those orders. I would not have run the silent script without that record.

B2 · Customer Obsession AIQB: Customer Obsession Q4 · story V1 · S11

"Give me an example of a time when you asked for customer feedback. How did you use that feedback to drive innovation or improvement? How did the customer respond?"

Opener: "The most useful customer feedback I've had came as a criticism of me: leadership said our visibility product wasn't showing value, and the real customers' feedback was hiding inside our own wave data."

S At Flexport I owned the Shipment Visibility launch across nine teams. Seven pilot customers were on it at $0.66 cost to serve per container; Sales wanted the whole pool boarded at once; leadership said the program was not demonstrating value.

T I had to turn customer experience into evidence that could steer the rollout, and board customers only as fast as the product could serve them well.

A I set a calibration entry bar of about 50 containers per client so each new customer's own data told us whether we were ready for them. I wrote six graduation criteria and published them to Sales before wave one. I froze seven metrics in a weekly review copied from an existing leadership review. In wave three the customer signal said ETA accuracy was off; I traced it to one bad data source and held the wave in public rather than give twenty-plus customers a bad first impression. We fixed the source, then boarded them.

R We went from 7 to 68 customers — 9.7 times — with zero rollbacks, and cost to serve fell from $0.66 to $0.03 per container, about 95%. The customers we held became the cleanest wave. The VP unlocked the full rollout two months early off the review.

Number to land: 7 → 68 customers (9.7×); $0.66 → $0.03, about 95% record · **Do not say:** "ten times"; "I invented the WBR" — I copied a trusted format
Likely follow-up: "How did Sales take the hold?" — They had the six criteria before wave one, so the hold was the rule firing, not my opinion. That is why I publish gates before the first wave — it turns a fight into a check.
Note. The hiring manager heard Shipment Visibility as an operating story; here the angle is the customer signal and the held wave.

B3 · Ownership AIQB: Ownership Q1 · story V4 · S16

"Tell me about a time when you took on something significant outside your area of responsibility. Why was it important? What was the outcome?"

Opener: "I wrote the requirements for a data pipeline no one had asked me to own, because a VP was steering on a number that only I could break."

S At Flexport the Monday review for Shipment Visibility ran on four systems that didn't talk, stitched together in Google Sheets by one person — me. Accuracy was 60%, tickets carried no container ID, and each snapshot took 1.5 to 2 hours.

T Data infrastructure was not my team. Nobody had written requirements for a program's operating metrics. I took the BRD and the cutover; the infra team owned the build.

A I documented the as-is and named the join gap. I priced the status quo at over $100K a year in the infra team's own loaded rates, so they prioritized it themselves instead of me escalating. I froze the scope to the seven metrics already in the review — nothing new. I set acceptance as a parallel run within 1% for consecutive weeks, and I kept running the manual pull every Monday as the rollback so the review never skipped a week. We used a cross-reference table for the ticket join first, then pushed a real key upstream.

R Accuracy went from 60% to 90%, the bus factor went from one to at least two, and the first automated catch was a 4% ticket-sync drop that had been invisible in the manual era.

Number to land: accuracy 60% → 90%; >$100K a year *priced* baseline record · **Do not say:** "we saved $100K" — it was a price on the status quo; "I built the pipeline" — infra built it
Likely follow-up: "What went wrong?" — I didn't plan the data-access security review; it cost two weeks. I told my manager the same day it surfaced and re-sequenced, and we skipped zero review deliveries. Every kickoff now asks whose approval the data needs and how long it takes.

B4 · Ownership AIQB: Ownership Q2 · story V8 · G1

"Describe a time when you didn't think you were going to meet a commitment you promised. How did you identify the risk and communicate it to stakeholders? Is there anything you would do differently?"

Opener: "Two days before a UAT sign-off I had promised, I learned my test plan had missed the one thing that mattered to the customer — and I made it worse before I made it better."

S At Elementum I owned readiness for a customer's track-and-trace application. Five key users had passed all ten end-to-end scenarios; sign-off was two days away.

T Earn the sign-off, including requirements the written scenario list had not made explicit.

A When the sponsor opened access more broadly, concurrent logins crashed the system. My first reaction was wrong: I reran my scenarios, they passed, and I sent screenshots. Then I stopped defending the plan and reproduced the customer's actual shape — many users at once. I told the sponsor plainly that the gap was mine: their users had exposed a performance requirement I failed to surface. Engineering simulated the concurrent load and worked the fix while I rewrote the UAT contract with numeric uptime, page-load and concurrent-load criteria at the customer's user count, data volume and network.

R The sign-off date was missed and confidence had to be rebuilt. What changed permanently is that every critical scenario I own now has numeric entrance and exit criteria, including load at the customer's shape.

Number to land: 5 users × 10 scenarios passed; concurrency crashed it 2 days before sign-off; date missed record · **Do not say:** "the sponsor caused it by opening access" — their users behaved as their work required
Likely follow-up: "How did you communicate it?" — To the sponsor first, as my miss, with what we knew, what we didn't, and when they would hear next. Then to my own leadership with the same words. No screenshots the second time.

B5 · Invent and Simplify AIQB: Invent and Simplify Q3 · story V9 · UDC-B4

"Tell me about a time when you were able to make something simpler for customers. What drove you to implement this change? What was the impact?"

Opener: "At Sephora's Utah DC a store and a dotcom shopper could ask for the same unit in the same building and get two different answers — I made it one answer."

S The building ran as two systemic warehouses — Dotcom and Retail — with duplicate receiving, split storage, internal self-transfers and two planning views.

T I owned the requirement set and the customer outcome: the minimum change that would make one promise true.

A I wrote the customer problem first: one inventory, one promise, two channels — a single location with the Dotcom selling location mapped onto it. I ranked the requirements with one test: does the customer's promise become false without this? Location setup, PO creation with channel reserves, the conversion script and the OMS source node passed. History conversion, reserve-math improvements and a reporting rebuild did not, and went onto a written deferral list. The issues log carried that triage in its own categories — 331 go-live, 77 fast-follow, 36 enhancement.

R Two go-lives with zero customer-facing incidents, and processing efficiency up 15% by DC Ops' own measurement. My miss: analysts lived with two systems of record for four months; the interim reporting deserved a workstream on day one.

Number to land: zero customer-facing incidents across two go-lives; +15% by DC Ops' measurement record · **Do not say:** "nine reserve buckets" — there were three; that it "held to the day" — design was planned for Jul 26 and signed Aug 14
Likely follow-up: "Why not convert history?" — It would have touched every downstream system's past rows for a benefit no shopper would feel. We copied forward only what planning needed — sales history and forecast — and wrote "no conversion of historical transactions" on the scope slide.

B6 · Invent and Simplify AIQB: Invent and Simplify Q5 · story V7 · I1

"Tell me about a time when you had a challenging problem or situation that the usual approach wouldn't address. How did you select an alternative approach? What alternative approach(es) did you consider? What was the end result? What was the impact?"

Opener: "The usual approach to an LLM product is to pick the best model and tune prompts; for an incident-triage agent that gave me good answers at $25 each with no way to check them."

S I independently built a Python/FastAPI triage agent for operational incident queues. The naive version produced useful proposals but cost $25 per incident and could answer without a checkable chain of evidence.

T Make it operations-grade: quality held on known cases, every proposal checkable, unit cost under a dollar — and not present it as an employer deployment.

A I considered three paths: one premium model for everything, prompt tuning alone, or treating it as a product with a quality contract. I chose the contract. I graded historical incidents with known-correct outcomes into an eval set and made it the release gate — every change had to keep the past passing. I added one rule: no citation, no proposal — each action bound to ticket evidence and a runbook line. Then I measured cost by incident class and routed routine classes to smaller models, reserving expensive calls for the hard tail.

R Cost fell from $25 to $0.40 per incident — 98% — with 100% citation coverage and accuracy held on the eval set.

Number to land: $25 → $0.40 per incident, 98%; 100% citations record · **Do not say:** "deployed at my employer"; "zero errors" — the claim is accuracy held on the eval set

Likely follow-up: "What would you do differently?" — My first eval set kept growing while I was judging early prompts, so early comparisons weren't clean. I would freeze and version the baseline before the first experiment.

B7 · Are Right, A Lot AIQB: Are Right, A Lot Q5 · story V8 · G1

"We don't always make the right judgment all the time. Tell me about a time when you made an error in judgment. What was the impact? What did you learn? How have you applied what you learned?"

Opener: "My clearest error in judgment was not the test plan I missed — it was the hour after, when I tried to prove I was right instead of finding out what the customer saw."

S At Elementum, two days before UAT sign-off on a track-and-trace app, five key users had passed all ten scenarios. The sponsor opened access broadly, and users said they could not complete a flow.

T I owned readiness; my job in that moment was to find the truth fast.

A My judgment call was to rerun my scenarios. They passed, and I sent the sponsor screenshots. That was defending my coverage. When it was clear users were still blocked, I reproduced their real shape — many concurrent logins — and the system crashed. I went back to the sponsor and said the gap was mine. Engineering simulated the load and fixed it; I rewrote the readiness criteria in numbers: uptime, page load and concurrent load at the customer's user count, data volume and network.

R The sign-off date was missed and trust had to be rebuilt. I've applied it since: in any escalation, the first hour goes to reproducing the customer's shape, and "works for us" is never readiness evidence.

Number to land: 2 days before sign-off; 5 users × 10 scenarios; date missed record · **Do not say:** a small or blame-shifting failure; "the system was fine, the users were wrong"

Likely follow-up: "How do you know the lesson stuck?" — My next major launch gate at Flexport was written in load terms — a volume of containers in a fixed time at a connectivity threshold — and passed before customers touched it.

B8 · Are Right, A Lot AIQB: Are Right, A Lot Q3 · story V2 · Crux

"Tell me about a time when you made a difficult decision with input from many different sources (customers, stakeholders, partner teams, etc.). What was the situation and how did you arrive at your decision? Did the decision turn out to be the correct one? Why or why not?"

Opener: "When Flexport retired an acquired visibility product, the hard part was not the migration — it was deciding, customer segment by segment, who we should keep and who we should honestly let go."

S Crux had 79 customers — $185,892 of ARR and 294,581 containers in 2021 — and the aim was to move them to Shipment Visibility by end 2022. Shipment Visibility did not fit every segment.

T I owned the Shipment Visibility side: which segments our product could serve without new build, and how they would board. The RAPID's recommenders and decider are named in the document. VERIFY my exact RAPID role

A The inputs pulled in different directions. One leader wanted Flexport to be the data authority — everyone on our milestones. Another asked for the cost of keeping two systems. A third wrote that ejecting customers is never a good experience and asked about feature parity and consignee timing. Account owners knew which brokers mattered: one held a national home-improvement retailer's account and was part of a 600-truck drayage company we wanted a relationship with. The decision became one rule per segment: shippers — GKA 2, Enterprise 14, SMB 39 — to Shipment Visibility; forwarders, customs brokers and 3PLs to the SV API with no extra dev, or cancel; two brokers to a partner product; the two competitor SaaS accounts cancelled.

R Every one of the 79 had a decided, dated path. The competitor accounts were cancelled on August 1 and October 24, 2022. I think it was right because no segment was force-fit into a product that didn't serve it.

Number to land: 79 customers; $185,892 ARR; 294,581 containers record-from-docs · **Do not say:** any preserved-ARR or churn number — the document has none
Likely follow-up: "Was cancelling paying customers customer-obsessed?" — Force-fitting a segment we didn't serve would have turned this year's revenue into next year's churn plus support cost. A clean cancel with notice and a path — the API or a partner product — kept it honest.

B9 · Learn and Be Curious AIQB: Learn and Be Curious Q5 · story V7 · I1

"Give me an example of a time when you explored a new or unexpected area of an existing space. Why hadn't this been explored already? Why did you move forward? What were the results or what was the impact?"

Opener: "Incident triage is an old space. The part nobody had productized was an LLM that is not allowed to propose an action it cannot cite."

S I independently built a Python/FastAPI triage agent for operational incident queues. The usual exploration stopped at prompt quality. The naive version cost $25 per incident and could answer with no checkable evidence.

T Find whether a cheaper, checkable path existed, and prove it on known cases before I trusted it.

A Demos stop when the answer looks right, so the eval set rarely gets built. I moved forward because an uncited proposal creates work. I graded historical incidents with known-correct outcomes into an eval set and made every change keep the past passing. I added one rule: no citation, no proposal — ticket evidence and a runbook line. Then I split cost by incident class and routed the easy classes to smaller models.

R Cost fell from $25 to $0.40 per incident — 98% — with 100% citation coverage, and accuracy held on the eval set.

Number to land: $25 → $0.40 per incident, 98%; 100% citations record · **Do not say:** that it was deployed at an employer; "I am an ML engineer"
Likely follow-up: "What would you do differently?" — Freeze and version the eval baseline before the first prompt change. My early set grew while I was still judging prompts, so the first comparisons were soft.

B10 · Learn and Be Curious AIQB: Learn and Be Curious Q1 · story V4 · S16

"Tell me about a time when you realized you needed a deeper level of subject matter expertise to do your job well. What did you do about it? What was the outcome? Is there anything you would have done differently?"

Opener: "I could stitch four systems into a Monday number. I could not yet write a pipeline a data-access review would pass, and that gap cost two weeks."

S At Flexport the Monday review for Shipment Visibility ran on four systems in Google Sheets. Accuracy was 60%, tickets had no container ID, and a VP was steering on a number only I could produce.

T I had taken the BRD. I needed enough of the infra team's craft, and of data-access review, to write requirements they would build and a gate they could pass.

A I learned the join by writing the as-is: the missing container ID. I learned their prioritization language by pricing the status quo at over $100K a year in their own loaded rates. I learned the acceptance bar from them — a parallel run within 1% for consecutive weeks — and I kept my manual pull as the rollback so the review never skipped a Monday. The expertise I picked up too late was the data-access security review. It surfaced mid-build. I told my manager the same day and re-sequenced.

R Accuracy went from 60% to 90%, with zero Mondays skipped. Differently: at kickoff I ask whose approval the data needs and how long it takes, and that date goes in the BRD.

Number to land: accuracy 60% → 90%; two-week security-review miss, owned the same day record · **Do not say:** "we saved $100K" — the figure is a priced baseline; "I built the pipeline" — infra built it
Likely follow-up: "What do you still hand to a specialist?" — The build. I can write the definitions, the price, and the 1% gate. I still have an infra team build the pipeline.

B11 · Hire and Develop the Best AIQB: Hire and Develop the Best Q4 · story V4 · S16

"Tell me about a time when you provided coaching for a team member. What started the coaching? What was the outcome?"

Opener: "The coaching started because the Monday review had a bus factor of one — me — and a number that dies when I am out is not a system."

S Four systems, one Google Sheet, accuracy 60%. I was the only person who could produce the review.

T Leave a second owner who could trust the number without calling me. I led this without line authority. The second seat was a peer on the review, and the record has no promotion to claim.

A I coached with a gate, not a lecture. I froze the seven metric definitions and had them live in the pipeline, so the next owner inherited a spec. I kept running the manual pull every Monday beside the new path until the parallel run stayed within 1% for consecutive weeks. Where the two paths matched, they could trust it. Where they did not, we fixed the pipeline before cutover. Infra built the pipeline. I owned the standard they had to meet, and I stayed on the old path until that standard passed.

R Accuracy went from 60% to 90%, and the bus factor went from one to at least two. The first automated catch — a 4% ticket-sync drop — was found by the system.

Number to land: bus factor one → at least two; accuracy 60% → 90% record · **Do not say:** "my direct report"; any promotion or headcount
Likely follow-up: "What did you actually say?" — I handed over the seven definitions and the 1% rule, and I stayed on the manual pull until the rule passed. A document without that parallel week would have been a handover, not coaching.

B12 · Hire and Develop the Best AIQB: Hire and Develop the Best Q3 · story V1 · S11

"Give me an example of a time you provided feedback to develop the strengths of someone on your team. Were you able to positively impact their performance?"

Opener: "The people I was developing owned the inputs — Data Services, Support, and GTM. My feedback was that each of them would sign the definition they would be red against."

S I owned the Shipment Visibility launch across nine teams. Each team could see its own slice. A metric nobody had signed could not steer a VP.

T Turn strong specialists into owners of one definition each. They were peers, not my direct reports.

A I wrote seven metric definitions. The feedback to each input owner was specific: your strength is this input, and the review will use your signature. When wave three showed ETA accuracy off, that signature let us trace it to one bad source. I held the wave in public on their data, which made their judgment the decision instead of my summary.

R The customers we held became the cleanest wave. We went from 7 to 68 customers — 9.7 times — with zero rollbacks. I would start the signing on day one. I started the weekly review after the critique.

Number to land: 7 → 68 customers (9.7×); zero rollbacks record · **Do not say:** they were my direct reports; "I invented the WBR" — I copied a trusted format
Likely follow-up: "How do you know their performance moved?" — The hold was their signed definition firing, and those customers became the cleanest wave. That is the performance I can point to. There is no performance-rating change in the record.

B13 · Insist on the Highest Standards AIQB: Insist on the Highest Standards Q4 · story V8 · G1

"Tell me about a time when you had to make a decision between standards and delivery. What tradeoffs did you have make? What was the outcome? Knowing what you know now, would you have done anything differently?"

Opener: "Two days before a sign-off I had promised, I chose the standard I had forgotten to write, and I missed the date."

S At Elementum I owned readiness for a track-and-trace app. Five key users had passed all ten end-to-end scenarios. Then the sponsor opened access broadly and concurrent logins crashed the system.

T Decide whether "my scenarios passed" was allowed to stand in for ready.

A The tradeoff was a waiver that kept the date, against an honest miss. A waiver would have asked the customer to accept a system we had not proven at their shape — many users at once. I told the sponsor the gap was mine. Engineering simulated the concurrent load and fixed it. I rewrote the UAT contract with numeric uptime, page-load, and concurrent-load criteria at the customer's user count, data volume, and network.

R The sign-off date was missed, and confidence had to be rebuilt. Differently: I would put load, at the customer's shape, into the entrance criteria before the first scenario.

Number to land: 5 users × 10 scenarios passed; all-user concurrency failed 2 days before sign-off; date missed record · **Do not say:** "the sponsor caused it by opening access"; "we held the date with a waiver"
Likely follow-up: "What did the miss cost the customer?" — The date, and a week of trust I had to earn back by showing the new load criteria, not another screenshot.

B14 · Insist on the Highest Standards AIQB: Insist on the Highest Standards Q2 · story V5 · S9

"Tell me about a time when you were unsatisfied with the status quo. What did you do to change it? What was the impact? Would you do anything differently in the future?"

Opener: "Sixty percent data completeness, with the high-value lanes blind, was a status quo I would not automate."

S A customer's Global Head of Supply Chain wanted inbound visibility on a thousand lanes in two months. Completeness was 60%.

T I owned the scope analysis and the onboarding standard. Engineers built the maps.

A I built the spend Pareto: 597 lanes carried 80% of freight spend. I pre-validated it with Transportation and Procurement, then took it two levels above my sponsor. I published a 95% valid-ASN gate and held a cohort twice when it failed on a timestamp format. I set an XML and portal floor so a small carrier could meet the same standard without a custom build.

R Completeness reached 95%. About 200 lanes followed behind the same gate, and freight spend fell about 10%, roughly $2M in six months. Differently: I would publish that gate in the kickoff deck.

Number to land: a thousand lanes asked; 597 carrying 80% of spend first; completeness 60% → 95% record · **Do not say:** we onboarded all thousand lanes in the first wave; the $2M is "savings I booked" — it is the freight-spend move in the record
Likely follow-up: "Why hold a cohort that was already late?" — A timestamp-format failure makes every downstream ETA fiction. Shipping it would have turned the 95% gate into a slogan.

B15 · Think Big AIQB: Think Big Q1 · story V1 · S11

"Tell me about time when you were working on an initiative or goal and saw an opportunity to do something much bigger or better than the initial focus. Did you take that opportunity? Why or why not? What was the outcome?"

Opener: "The ask was to show that a visibility program had value. I took the bigger version: a product Sales could graduate without me in the room."

S At Flexport, seven pilot customers were on Shipment Visibility at $0.66 cost to serve per container. Sales wanted the whole pool boarded at once. Leadership said the program was not demonstrating value.

T I owned the launch across nine teams. A better status report would have answered the critique once. A graduation rule would answer it every wave.

A I took the rule. I published six graduation criteria to Sales before wave one, set an entry bar of about 50 containers per client so each customer's own freight was the test, and froze seven metrics in a weekly review copied from one leadership already trusted. When wave three missed ETA accuracy on one bad source, I held the wave in public. That hold is what made the criteria a product decision.

R We went from 7 to 68 customers — 9.7 times — with zero rollbacks. Cost to serve fell from $0.66 to $0.03 per container, about 95%. The VP unlocked the full rollout two months early.

Number to land: 7 → 68 customers (9.7×); $0.66 → $0.03, about 95% record · **Do not say:** "ten times"; "I invented the WBR"
Likely follow-up: "Why refuse the faster boarding?" — The first two quarters were slower on purpose. The customers we held became the cleanest wave, and that record is what unlocked the early rollout.

B16 · Think Big AIQB: Think Big Q3 · story V2 · Crux

"Give me an example of a time you proposed a novel approach to a problem. What was the problem and why did it require a novel approach? Was your approach successful?"

Opener: "Retiring an acquired product usually means migrating everyone. That approach fails when the product you are migrating them to does not fit every segment you just bought."

S Crux had 79 customers — $185,892 of ARR and 294,581 containers in 2021 — and the aim was to move them onto Shipment Visibility by the end of 2022. Shipment Visibility did not serve every segment.

T I owned the Shipment Visibility side: which segments we could serve with no new build. The RAPID's recommenders and decider are named in the document. VERIFY my exact RAPID role

A Migrate-all meant building parity for segments we did not serve. Cancel-all threw away shippers who fit. I proposed one rule, applied the same way to every segment: shippers — GKA 2, Enterprise 14, SMB 39 — to Shipment Visibility; forwarders, customs brokers, and 3PLs to the SV API with no extra dev, or a clean cancel; two brokers to a partner product; the two competitor SaaS accounts cancelled on published dates.

R It was successful in the way I can source. Every one of the 79 had a decided, dated path. The competitor accounts were cancelled on August 1 and October 24, 2022.

Number to land: 79 customers; $185,892 ARR; 294,581 containers record-from-docs · **Do not say:** any preserved-ARR or churn figure — the document has none

Likely follow-up: "What made it novel rather than a segmentation slide?" — The same rule produced the cancels. A segmentation that only describes the customers you keep is a sales story.

B17 · Bias for Action AIQB: Bias for Action Q2 · story V6 · S13

"Tell me about a time when you worked against tight deadlines and didn't have time to consider all options before making a decision. How much time did you have? What approach did you take? What did you learn from the situation?"

Opener: "I had the hours between a 4 AM call and the morning surge. Inventory was on the shelf, and backorders were piling up."

S I was the OMS consultant on allocation and promising for a retailer with 3 DCs and 100 stores. On Cyber Monday the VP called at 4 AM. About $6M of sales was at risk against a 95% fill goal. Available-to-promise sat above zero while backorders rose.

T Protect that morning's promises. I did not yet know the cause.

A I had hours, not a day, so I skipped a full root-cause workshop and I skipped first-in-first-out. I ranked clears by promise at risk, rebalanced so no DC drowned, and logged every move with a timestamp so each one stayed reversible. In parallel I traced the contradiction and found the allocation scheduler had died silently at the daylight-saving change. Engineering fixed it once I had isolated it.

R We delivered 99% fill and protected about $8M of that day's sales. What I learned: a clearing rule has to exist before the peak. Nobody, including me, had written one.

Number to land: 99% fill; about $8M of that day's sales protected; about $6M had been at risk record · **Do not say:** the $8M was the amount at risk; any margin figure — that is my model

Likely follow-up: "What did you leave on the table by moving fast?" — A complete cause analysis before the first clear. The log is what made that acceptable: every rebalance could be undone.

B18 · Bias for Action AIQB: Bias for Action Q4 · story V1 · S11

"Tell me about a time when you had to gather information and respond immediately to a situation. What was the outcome? Would you have done anything differently?"

Opener: "Wave three missed its ETA-accuracy criterion, and I held the wave in that same review."

S I had published six graduation criteria to Sales before wave one of Shipment Visibility. In wave three, ETA accuracy missed. The next boarding was twenty-plus customers.

T Decide that week whether those customers got a first impression on a bad source.

A The information I needed was the source of the miss, not a longer debate. I traced it to one bad data source, held the wave in public, and we fixed the source before boarding. The criteria were already in Sales' hands, so the hold was the rule firing.

R Those customers became the cleanest wave. We still went from 7 to 68 customers — 9.7 times — with zero rollbacks, and cost to serve fell from $0.66 to $0.03 per container. Differently: I would have started the weekly review on day one, so the forum existed before the first miss.

Number to land: 7 → 68 customers (9.7×); $0.66 → $0.03 record · **Do not say:** "ten times"; that I held the wave on a hunch
Likely follow-up: "What would have counted as enough information to board anyway?" — The source fixed, and the ETA criterion back inside the bar we had published. A plan to fix it later was not enough.

B19 · Frugality AIQB: Frugality Q5 · story V7 · I1

"Tell me about a time when you generated a creative solution to a problem or project without requiring additional resources. What was the problem? What was the solution and how did you come up with it? What was the outcome?"

Opener: "At $25 an incident, the obvious fix was a bigger budget. I got to forty cents by sending the easy incidents to a smaller model."

S I independently built a triage agent. The naive version was useful, cost $25 per incident, and could answer without a citation.

T Bring unit cost under a dollar with accuracy held, on the stack I already had. This was not an employer program and it had no budget to expand.

A I came to the solution from the eval set, not from a vendor conversation. Graded historical incidents showed that most classes were easy. I routed those to smaller models and kept expensive calls for the hard tail. Every routing change had to keep the eval set passing, and every proposal still had to cite the ticket and the runbook. No new headcount and no new vendor.

R Cost fell from $25 to $0.40 per incident — 98% — with 100% citation coverage and accuracy held on the eval set.

Number to land: $25 → $0.40 per incident, 98%; 100% citations record · **Do not say:** that it was deployed at an employer; "we saved a budget line"
Likely follow-up: "Where did you accept worse answers?" — Nowhere on the eval set. The spend I did make was my own time to build the set and keep it versioned.

B20 · Frugality AIQB: Frugality Q3 · story V4 · S16

"Tell me about a time when you didn't have enough resources to do something you felt was important but found a creative way to get it done anyway. What was the situation? What other options did you consider? How did you decide on a path forward? What was the outcome?"

Opener: "A VP was steering on a Monday number that took me two hours to assemble, and I had no team and no budget to replace the spreadsheet."

S Four systems, accuracy 60%, 1.5 to 2 hours a snapshot, bus factor one. The infra team was not mine.

T Get one pipeline without asking for headcount.

A I considered three paths: hire analysts to share the manual pull, pause the review until someone funded a rebuild, or price the status quo so the team that already owned the stack would take it. I chose the price. I put it at over $100K a year in the infra team's own loaded rates, and I froze the scope to the seven metrics already in the review. I kept running the manual pull every Monday as the rollback, so the build consumed no extra review capacity. The path forward was accepted only when a parallel run stayed within 1% for consecutive weeks.

R They prioritized the build. Accuracy went from 60% to 90%. The first automated catch was a 4% ticket-sync drop. The hundred thousand is the price I used to get the slot. It is not a savings claim.

Number to land: >$100K a year priced, not saved; accuracy 60% → 90% record · **Do not say:** "we saved $100K"; "I staffed a data team"
Likely follow-up: "Why not contractors?" — A contractor arrives after more Mondays have already been steered on a 60% number. The scarce resource was a build slot on the team that owned the stack, and their own rate card unlocked it.

B21 · Earn Trust AIQB: Earn Trust Q4 · story V8 · G1

"Give me an example of a time when you were not able to meet a commitment. What was the commitment and what were the obstacles that prevented success? What was the impact to your customers/peers and what did you learn from it?"

Opener: "I had committed a UAT sign-off date, and the obstacle that broke it was my own test plan."

S At Elementum, five key users had passed all ten scenarios. Sign-off was two days away. Concurrent logins then crashed the system.

T The commitment was that date. I owned readiness.

A My criteria covered the happy-path scenarios and omitted load. I made the trust problem worse first: I reran my scenarios and sent screenshots. Then I reproduced the customer's shape — many users at once — told the sponsor the gap was mine, and said the date would move. Engineering simulated the load and fixed it. I rewrote the contract with numeric load criteria.

R The customer lost the date. The engineering peers lost a sign-off they had been marching toward, because my entrance criteria had been too thin. I learned that "passed my scenarios" is not a commitment I can make.

Number to land: 5 users × 10 scenarios passed; concurrency failed 2 days before sign-off; date missed record · **Do not say:** the customer moved the date; engineering missed the commitment
Likely follow-up: "What did you say, and to whom first?" — The sponsor first: the gap was mine, here is what we know, here is when you hear next. Then the same words to my own leadership. No screenshots the second time.

B22 · Earn Trust AIQB: Earn Trust Q1 · story V2 · Crux

"Tell me about a time when you had to communicate a change in direction that you anticipated people would have concerns with. What did you do to understand the concerns and mitigate them? Were there any changes you made along the way after hearing these concerns? How did you handle questions and/or resistance? Were you able to get people comfortable with the change?"

Opener: "The change in direction was that not every Crux customer was coming to Shipment Visibility, and the account owners were the people I expected to resist it."

S Crux had 79 customers — $185,892 of ARR and 294,581 containers in 2021. The standing aim was to move them all by the end of 2022.

T Communicate a segment rule that included honest cancels. VERIFY my exact RAPID role

A The concerns were already in the review, and I treated them as requirements. One leader wanted every customer on our milestones. Another asked for the cost of keeping two systems — that number belonged in my first draft. A third wrote that ejecting a customer is never a good experience. Account owners named two brokers who carried most of the volume, one of them tied to a 600-truck drayage relationship. I changed those two paths: a partner product and an individual call, not a form letter. Competitor SaaS accounts still cancelled, on published dates. Every question got the same test: does Shipment Visibility serve this segment with no extra build?

R Every one of the 79 had a dated path, and the competitor accounts were cancelled on August 1 and October 24, 2022. The document records the paths. It does not record that every account owner felt comfortable, so I don't claim that.

Number to land: 79 customers; $185,892 ARR; 294,581 containers record-from-docs · **Do not say:** preserved ARR; "everyone was comfortable with the cancels"
Likely follow-up: "What actually changed after you heard the concerns?" — The two high-volume brokers moved to a partner product with individual calls. The competitor accounts stayed on the cancel dates. A concern changed a path only when the segment rule allowed it.

B23 · Dive Deep AIQB: Dive Deep Q2 · story V6 · S13

"Tell me about a situation that required you to dig deep to get to the root cause. How did you know you were focusing on the right things? What was the outcome? Would you have done anything differently?"

Opener: "The first explanation in the room was capacity. The screen contradicted it: available-to-promise was above zero while backorders rose."

S Cyber Monday, 4 AM, a retailer with 3 DCs and 100 stores. About $6M of sales was at risk against a 95% fill goal.

T Find the cause, and keep clearing orders while I looked.

A I knew the capacity theory was the wrong focus because a capacity problem does not leave ATP above zero. I traced allocation and found the scheduler had died silently at the daylight-saving change. Clears were already ranked by promise at risk and logged, so the dig did not freeze the morning. Engineering fixed the scheduler after I isolated it. After the peak I wrote the heartbeat, the DST checklist, the 3σ page, and the rehearsed rebalance playbook.

R We delivered 99% fill and protected about $8M of that day's sales. Differently: the heartbeat exists before the peak, so silence itself is the page.

Number to land: 99% fill; about $8M of that day's sales protected record · **Do not say:** "I found it by instinct"; any margin figure
Likely follow-up: "Why the scheduler and not the orders?" — The inventory was present. The scheduler had stopped on the DST change, which is a clock event, not a demand spike.

B24 · Dive Deep AIQB: Dive Deep Q5 · story V5 · S9

"Tell me about a specific metric you have used to identify a need for a change in your department. Did you create the metric or was it already available? How did this and other information influence the change? What was the outcome of this change?"

Opener: "The metric already in the room was lane count. I created spend share, and that is what changed the build."

S A customer's Global Head wanted inbound visibility on a thousand lanes in two months. Completeness was 60%, and the high-value lanes were blind.

T Choose a build order that Transportation and Procurement could defend.

A Lane count was available, and it treated a small lane and a spend-heavy lane as the same job. I created the cut: spend × criticality × mode × volume. It showed 597 lanes carrying 80% of freight spend. I pre-validated that figure with Transportation and Procurement, then took it two levels above my sponsor. Together with 60% completeness, it changed the plan from all lanes at once to cohorts behind a 95% valid-ASN gate. I held a cohort twice when a timestamp format failed the gate.

R Completeness reached 95%, and about 200 further lanes followed on the same gate.

Number to land: 597 lanes carrying 80% of spend; completeness 60% → 95% record · **Do not say:** "597 is 80% of the lanes" — 80% is spend share

Likely follow-up: "Why not use the customer's own lane count?" — It cannot tell a blind high-spend lane from a blind low-spend lane. Spend share can, and no lane owner could contradict the cut once Transportation and Procurement had seen it.

B25 · Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit AIQB: Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit Q1 · story V3 · S14

"Tell me about a time when you strongly disagreed with your manager or peer on something you considered very important to the business. What was it and how did you handle it? Knowing what you know now, would you do anything differently?"

Opener: "Two days before an executive review, my manager wanted a quiet fix for $2.5 million of orders our two systems could not reconcile. I disagreed on the risk, not on the manners."

S I was a consultant at a Manhattan customer. OMS and WMS did not reconcile — about 200 orders, $2.5M of order value — and a $10M initiative rode on the review. The room favored a quiet back-end correction.

T I owned the recommendation. Once we chose, I owned the war room.

A I built a discrepancy census by cause on a sample of the 200, and I took it to my manager privately first. In the room I disagreed on one point: a cross-table script written in two days had no rollback, and an audit would turn a data issue into a trust issue. I offered to run the war room myself. We sent the customer the root cause, the plan, and the timeline before the review. They chose which orders mattered. We patched those line by line, with before-and-after evidence on each order.

R The prioritized set reconciled before the review, and the customer awarded the $10M initiative. That $10M is an initiative won. Differently: I would have proposed the standing, reason-coded reconciliation report before there was a crisis to justify it.

Number to land: about 200 orders, $2.5M of order value; $10M initiative won record · **Do not say:** "we saved $10M"; "the customer was angry"

Likely follow-up: "If your manager had overruled you, then what?" — I would have asked for the decision in writing, with an owner, and a tripwire: any audit query on those orders stops the silent script. I would not have run that script without the record.

B26 · Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit AIQB: Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit Q2 · story V5 · S9

"Describe a time when you took an unpopular stance in a meeting with peers and your leader. What was it? Why did you feel strongly about it? What did you do? What was the outcome?"

Opener: "The customer's Global Head wanted a thousand lanes in two months. I told the room we would build 597 first."

S Completeness was 60%, and the high-value lanes were blind. The popular path was to accept the lane count.

T I owned the scope recommendation. Peers wanted the customer's number taken as the plan.

A I felt strongly because automating 60% complete data produces confident wrong answers, and a small lane is not the same job as a lane that carries the spend. I pre-validated the Pareto with Transportation and Procurement — 597 lanes carrying 80% of freight spend — and took it two levels above my sponsor. I published a 95% valid-ASN gate, held a cohort twice when a timestamp format failed it, and set an XML and portal floor so a small carrier stayed inside the same standard.

R Completeness reached 95%. About 200 lanes followed on that gate, and freight spend fell about 10%, roughly $2M in six months.

Number to land: a thousand lanes asked; 597 carrying 80% of spend first; completeness 60% → 95% record · **Do not say:** all thousand lanes shipped in the first wave; that I won by title

Likely follow-up: "What if the Global Head had still demanded all thousand on the date?" — I would have committed to the thousand behind the same 95% gate, in cohorts, and I would have moved the date. I would not have committed to the count and the date together.

B27 · Deliver Results AIQB: Deliver Results Q1 · story V6 · S13

"Give me an example of a time when you were able to deliver an important project under a tight deadline. What sacrifices did you have to make to meet the deadline? How did they impact the final deliverable? What was the final outcome?"

Opener: "The deadline was the morning surge on Cyber Monday. The deliverable was fill rate, not a finished post-mortem."

S At 4 AM the VP called. A retailer with 3 DCs and 100 stores had backorders piling up with inventory present. About $6M of sales was at risk against a 95% fill goal.

T Deliver that morning's promises.

A I sacrificed a complete diagnosis before the first clear, and I sacrificed first-in-first-out. I ranked by promise at risk, rebalanced so no DC drowned, and logged every move so the sacrifice stayed reversible. The scheduler fix — it had died silently at the daylight-saving change — and the heartbeat came after the peak. They were not allowed to delay the clears.

R We delivered 99% fill and protected about $8M of that day's sales. The narrower deliverable is why the mechanisms exist now: the morning was spent on the orders, and the playbook was written from the log.

Number to land: 99% fill; about $8M of that day's sales protected record · **Do not say:** the post-mortem finished before the surge; any margin figure

Likely follow-up: "What did the sacrifice cost a customer?" — Some orders waited behind higher-promise ones. The timestamped log is how I can say which ones, and why.

B28 · Deliver Results AIQB: Deliver Results Q4 · story V2 · Crux

"Tell me about a time when you or your team were more than half way to meeting a goal when you realized it may not be the right goal or may have unintended consequences. What was the situation? What did you do? What was the outcome? Looking back, would you have done anything differently?"

Opener: "The goal was to move all 79 Crux customers onto Shipment Visibility. Partway there, that goal was wrong for several of the segments."

S Crux had 79 customers — $185,892 of ARR and 294,581 containers in 2021 — and the program was already aimed at a full move by the end of 2022.

T Change the goal before we started building parity for segments we would then have to support.

VERIFY my exact RAPID role

A I put one test on every segment: can Shipment Visibility serve them with no extra dev? Shippers passed — GKA 2, Enterprise 14, SMB 39. Forwarders, customs brokers, and 3PLs did not, and a parity build halfway through would have created the support queue I was trying to avoid. Two brokers went to a partner product. The two competitor SaaS accounts were cancelled on dates. The unintended consequence I was refusing was next year's churn dressed up as this year's migration.

R Every customer had a dated path. The competitor cancels landed on August 1 and October 24, 2022. Differently: the cost of keeping Crux running belonged in the first draft. A reviewer had to ask for it.

Number to land: 79 customers; $185,892 ARR; 294,581 containers record-from-docs · **Do not say:** we completed "everyone migrated"; any preserved-ARR number

Likely follow-up: "How far along were you?" — Far enough that account owners already had a migration story to unwind, which is why the partner path and the individual calls had to be explicit. I don't have a percent-complete in the document, so I don't invent one.

B29 · Strive to be Earth's Best Employer AIQB: Earth's Best Employer Q5 · story V6 · S13

"Tell me about a time when you showed compassion toward someone during a stressful or high-pressure situation. How did you recognize that it was important to demonstrate sensitivity? What did you do to demonstrate compassion? What were the outcomes for that person and the situation?"

Opener: "At 4 AM on Cyber Monday the bridge was about to spend the morning guessing. I took the log so the next person onto the call would not have to re-decide the last hour."

S The VP called at 4 AM. Backorders were rising with inventory present, about $6M of sales at risk, on a retailer with 3 DCs and 100 stores. The people on the bridge could not pause the peak.

T Keep the morning moving, and keep each decision carryable by whoever walked in next.

A I recognized the pressure when the first ideas were "clear everything" and first-in-first-out. That is what a tired bridge does when the rule is unwritten. I ranked clears by promise at risk, rebalanced so no single DC drowned, and wrote every move with a timestamp so it was reversible and readable at 7 AM. After the peak I wrote the heartbeat, the daylight-saving checklist, and the rehearsed playbook, so the next peak did not depend on who answered the phone.

R We delivered 99% fill and protected about $8M of that day's sales. The outcome I will claim for the people on the bridge is the written playbook. I don't have a quote from them in the record, so I don't invent one.

Number to land: 99% fill; about $8M of that day's sales protected record · **Do not say:** "nobody was stressed"; a thank-you quote that is not in the record

Likely follow-up: "How is a log compassion?" — A bridge without a log makes every new person relive the last hour. The timestamped, reversible log is the part I can point to.

B30 · Strive to be Earth's Best Employer AIQB: Earth's Best Employer Q2 · story V9 · UDC-B4

"Tell me about a time when you advocated for someone who had less influence or seniority than you. How or why did you advocate for them and what was the outcome?"

Opener: "The analysts living in two books had less influence than the go-live date, and my scope ranking is what had put them there."

S At Sephora's Utah DC a store and a dotcom shopper could get two answers for one unit. I ranked requirements so the go-live set was the minimum that made one promise true. History conversion and the reporting rebuild were written onto the deferral list. Analysts then lived with two systems of record for four months.

T Give the people doing that interim work a named workstream. They had no vote in the go-live room.

A The customer test — does the shopper's promise become false without this? — correctly kept history conversion off the go-live. It also left the analysts planning across two books. I advocated for interim reporting as its own workstream. I was late: month three, not day one. The issues log already showed the triage — 331 go-live, 77 fast-follow, 36 enhancement — and reporting sat in the later buckets on purpose. The reserves in that design were three: Dotcom, Retail, and Uncommitted.

R Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents, and processing efficiency up 15% by DC Ops' measurement. The analysts had the workstream from month three. I would open it on day one.

Number to land: 331 go-live / 77 fast-follow / 36 enhancement; interim reporting from month three record · **Do not say:** nine reserve buckets; that the gate chain held to the day — functional design was planned for Jul 26 and signed Aug 14
Likely follow-up: "Why advocate for work you had already deferred?" — The deferral was right for the shopper. Silence about it was wrong for the analyst. A named workstream is how a deferred requirement keeps an owner and a date.

B31 · Success and Scale Bring Broad Responsibility AIQB: Success and Scale Bring Broad Responsibility Q2 · story V1 · S11

"Tell me about a time when you decided to change a decision because of unintended consequences for your customers. What was the impact to your customers? What tradeoffs did you have to make? How did your new solution better serve your customers?"

Opener: "We had decided to board wave three. I changed that decision when ETA accuracy missed, because twenty-plus customers were about to meet the product on a bad source."

S Six graduation criteria were already published to Sales. Wave three failed ETA accuracy. Sales still wanted the boarding. We were on the way from 7 pilot customers toward a much larger pool, at $0.66 cost to serve per container.

T Change the boarding decision before those customers' first impression was set.

A Boarding on the bad source would have taught a wrong ETA on day one, at the moment the program was trying to scale. I traced the miss to one source, held the wave in public, fixed the source, and then boarded them. The tradeoff was calendar time in that wave. The customers already live were not moved onto the bad week.

R The held customers became the cleanest wave. We reached 68 customers — 9.7 times — with zero rollbacks, and cost to serve fell from $0.66 to $0.03 per container, about 95%.

Number to land: 7 → 68 customers (9.7×); $0.66 → $0.03 record · **Do not say:** "ten times"; that the hold was free — it cost the calendar
Likely follow-up: "What did the held customers actually experience?" — A later start, on a fixed source. I don't have a separate satisfaction score for that cohort in this record, so I use the operational result: they were the cleanest wave, and we had zero rollbacks.

B32 · Success and Scale Bring Broad Responsibility **AIQB: Success and Scale Bring Broad Responsibility Q5 · story V5 · S9**

"Tell me about a time when you considered everyone who was affected by your work, not just your direct customers or people within your organization."

Opener: "The direct customer wanted a thousand lanes. The people also affected were the small carriers who would have been pushed out of the standard, and the lanes we chose not to build first."

S A Global Head of Supply Chain asked for inbound visibility on a thousand lanes in two months. Completeness was 60%. 597 lanes carried 80% of freight spend.

T Make the long tail and the small carriers a written decision, not a side effect of saying yes to the count.

A I put three groups on one page. The Global Head, who wanted count. Transportation and Procurement, who had to operate the cut — I pre-validated the 597 with them before I went two levels above my sponsor. And the small carriers, who could not fund a custom build: an XML and portal floor let them meet the same 95% valid-ASN gate. Lanes outside the 597 were written as follow-behind, not dropped. About 200 came through that gate later.

R Completeness reached 95%, and freight spend fell about 10%, roughly $2M in six months. Scale did not become "only the carriers who can afford a project."

Number to land: 597 lanes, 80% of spend; about 200 lanes followed; completeness 60% → 95% record · **Do not say:** the lanes outside the 597 were cancelled; small carriers were out of scope

Likely follow-up: "Who was left worse off?" — The lanes outside the 597 waited. They waited behind a published gate. A small carrier who could send XML or use the portal stayed in the same standard without funding a custom integration.

C · NEW — six behavioral questions not used with Tripathy, Hoerger, or Rocky's six NEW

Checked against panel-1 Tripathy, panel-2 Hoerger, and section 6 of Rocky's bar-raiser bank. Same 90-second shape. Stories stay inside the nine above.

N1 · Customer Obsession AIQB: Customer Obsession Q7 · story V5 · S9 NEW

"Sometimes customers make unreasonable requests. Tell me about a time when you've had to push back or say no to a customer request. What did you say or do in response to that request?"

Opener: "The Global Head asked for a thousand lanes in two months. I said no to the count and the date together, and yes to the 597 lanes that carried the spend."

S Inbound visibility was 60% complete, and the high-value lanes were blind. The request on the table was all thousand lanes, on that date.

T Answer the customer's actual need — see the freight that matters — without automating a 60% data set.

A I did not say no in the meeting and invent the alternative later. I built the spend Pareto first, pre-validated it with Transportation and Procurement, and then said the sentence: 597 lanes carry 80% of freight spend; those go first, behind a 95% valid-ASN gate; the rest follow the same gate; small carriers stay in via XML or a portal. I took that page two levels above my sponsor. When a cohort failed the gate on a timestamp format, I held it twice.

R Completeness reached 95%. About 200 lanes followed. Freight spend fell about 10%, roughly $2M in six months.

Number to land: a thousand asked; 597 carrying 80% of spend first; completeness 60% → 95% record · **Do not say:** "we ignored the customer"; the other lanes were cancelled
Likely follow-up: "What were the exact words?" — "We will not board a lane that fails the 95% gate, including one in the 597. The date moves before the gate does."

N2 · Are Right, A Lot AIQB: Are Right, A Lot Q6 · story V8 · G1 NEW

"Tell me about a time when you discovered that your idea was not the best course of action. What was your idea? Why wasn't your idea the best course of action? How did you find out it was not the correct path? What was the best course of action? Who provided it? What did you learn from the experience?"

Opener: "My idea was that ten passing scenarios, run by five key users, meant the product was ready to sign off. The customer's own concurrency proved that idea wrong."

S Two days before UAT sign-off on an Elementum track-and-trace app, five key users had passed all ten end-to-end scenarios.

T I owned readiness. My course of action was to defend the scenario list.

A The idea failed because the scenarios never put the customer's real shape on the system: many people logged in at once. I found out when the sponsor opened access and the system crashed. My next move was still the old idea — I reran the scenarios and sent screenshots. The better course came from the users, not from me: reproduce concurrent logins, which engineering then simulated and fixed. I rewrote the contract with numeric load criteria at their user count, data volume, and network.

R The sign-off date was missed. What I learned: the customer is the one who supplies the missing test, and "works in my scenarios" is a claim I retire the hour it conflicts with their shape.

Number to land: 5 users × 10 scenarios passed; all-user concurrency failed 2 days before sign-off; date missed record · **Do not say:** "the users used it wrong"; that I caught it on the first try
Likely follow-up: "Who provided the better path?" — The customer's users, by logging in together. Engineering built the simulation. The path was theirs; I adopted it after the screenshots failed.

N3 · Learn and Be Curious AIQB: Learn and Be Curious Q7 · story V7 · I1 NEW

"Tell me about a time when you used external trends to improve your own company's products or services. How did you keep up to date with external trends? How did you decide to apply them to your own company? What was the result?"

Opener: "I kept up with LLMs by building one, and I decided the right place to apply them was an independent triage agent — not an employer's production stack."

S Operational incident queues were still triaged by people reading tickets. The external trend was cheap, capable language models that would answer even when they had no evidence.

T Learn the trend by shipping a quality contract around it, and keep that work independent of any employer system.

A I kept up by building, in Python and FastAPI, not by summarizing articles. The decision rule for applying it: an answer with no citation does not go in front of an operator. I graded historical incidents into an eval set and made that the release gate. Easy classes went to smaller models; the hard tail kept the expensive calls. I did not install this on an employer's incident queue.

R On the independent build, cost fell from $25 to $0.40 per incident — 98% — with 100% citation coverage and accuracy held on the eval set. The result I will carry into a company product is the gate, and only after a human baseline is beaten in production evidence.

Number to land: $25 → $0.40 per incident, 98%; 100% citations record · **Do not say:** that it was deployed at an employer; "the company is already running this"

Likely follow-up: "So you didn't improve a company product?" — Correct. I improved my own ability to put a gate on the trend. At FBA scale I would keep a human approval step until production evidence beats the human baseline. Access review and data boundaries get scheduled at kickoff.

N4 · Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit AIQB: Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit Q8 · story V1 · S11 NEW

"Tell me about a time when the business gained something because you persisted for a length of time. Why were you so determined? How did it turn out?"

Opener: "I persisted for the first two quarters on six graduation criteria, while Sales wanted every customer boarded now."

S Shipment Visibility had 7 pilot customers at $0.66 cost to serve per container. Leadership had said the program was not showing value. The fast path was to board the pool.

T I owned the launch across nine teams. I was determined because a bad first impression, repeated across the customers we were about to add, would have been more expensive than a slow quarter.

A I published the six criteria to Sales before wave one and left them there. Each new customer entered on about 50 of their own containers. When wave three missed ETA accuracy on one bad source, I held the wave in public instead of retiring the criteria for that week. We fixed the source, then boarded them. I kept the weekly review on seven frozen metrics the whole way.

R The business gained the rollout: 7 to 68 customers, 9.7 times, zero rollbacks, cost to serve from $0.66 to $0.03 per container. The VP unlocked the full rollout two months early off that record.

Number to land: 7 → 68 customers (9.7×); $0.66 → $0.03; unlocked two months early record · **Do not say:** "ten times"; that the criteria were popular — they cost us speed for two quarters

Likely follow-up: "When would you have dropped the criteria?" — If a criterion could not be traced to a source and an owner. A hold I cannot explain is stubbornness. This hold traced to one bad source.

N5 · Success and Scale Bring Broad Responsibility AIQB: Success and Scale Bring Broad Responsibility Q3 · story V2 · Crux NEW

"Tell me about a time when you changed course because of the negative impact you were going to cause to a third-party."

Opener: "The course was 'move all 79 Crux customers onto our product.' I changed it where that move would have handed a third party a product that did not serve them."

S Crux had 79 customers — $185,892 of ARR and 294,581 containers in 2021 — aimed at Shipment Visibility by the end of 2022. Forwarders, customs brokers, 3PLs, and two competitor SaaS accounts were in that count.

T Avoid building a migration that would stick those parties with a tool, a support queue, or a fake promise.
VERIFY my exact RAPID role

A A full migration would have hurt the brokers who carried most of the volume — one of them sat inside a 600-truck drayage relationship we wanted to keep — and it would have forced competitor accounts onto a product they were not going to run. I changed course by segment. Shippers came to Shipment Visibility. Forwarders, brokers, and 3PLs got the API with no extra dev, or a cancel. Two brokers got a partner product and an individual call. The two competitor accounts were cancelled on published dates, August 1 and October 24, 2022.

R Every one of the 79 had a path that matched what we could actually operate. I don't claim a preserved-ARR number. The document doesn't have one.

Number to land: 79 customers; $185,892 ARR; 294,581 containers record-from-docs · **Do not say:** preserved ARR; "no third party was inconvenienced" — the competitor accounts were cancelled, on notice
Likely follow-up: "Was the cancel itself the harm?" — A cancel with a date and a reason is smaller harm than a year of a product that cannot file or forward for them. The partner path was the mitigation for the brokers who carried the volume.

N6 · Invent and Simplify AIQB: Invent and Simplify Q4 · story V9 · UDC-B4 NEW

"Describe a time when you influenced and drove new thinking and innovation out of your team. Give an example of how your approach led to a specific innovation."

Opener: "I gave the team one test — does the shopper's promise become false without this? — and they turned a pile of requirements into a go-live set and a written deferral list."

S At Sephora's Utah DC, Dotcom and Retail were two books in one building. A store and a dotcom shopper could get two answers for the same unit. The instinct in the room was to convert everything.

T I owned the requirement set. I needed the team to produce the minimum design that made one promise true, and to write down the rest.

A The approach was the test, applied in public. Location setup, PO creation with channel reserves, the conversion script, and the OMS source node passed. History conversion, reserve-math changes, and a reporting rebuild failed, and went on the deferral list. The team then sorted the issues log into that grammar: 331 go-live, 77 fast-follow, 36 enhancement. The specific innovation was one pool with two selling identities — a single location, the Dotcom selling location mapped onto it — and three reserve buckets: Dotcom, Retail, and Uncommitted. Canada, later, reused an existing cross-dock path, twenty small brands first.

R Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents, processing efficiency up 15% by DC Ops' measurement. My miss on the same program: analysts lived with two systems of record for four months, and the interim reporting workstream started in month three.

Number to land: 331 go-live / 77 fast-follow / 36 enhancement; zero customer-facing incidents record · **Do not say:** nine reserve buckets; that the gate chain held to the day — design was planned for Jul 26 and signed Aug 14
Likely follow-up: "What did the team invent that you did not hand them?" — The row-level sort. I wrote the test. They produced 331, 77, and 36, and that count is what both go-lives read.

D · Router — 16 Leadership Principles to story ids

Name the principle, tell the primary, land the number, stop. Backup only if he asks for another example. Product angle: Rocky heard program and cutover; James heard process and governance.

LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLE	PRIMARY · ANSWER	BACKUP	NUMBER TO LAND
Customer Obsession	B1 · S14 quiet-fix disagreement	B2 · V1 held wave	about 200 orders, $2.5M order value; $10M initiative won
Ownership	B3 · S16 BRD and cutover	B4 · G1 missed sign-off	Accuracy 60% → 90%; >$100K priced
Invent and Simplify	B5 · UDC-B4 one promise	B6 · I1 eval gate	331 / 77 / 36; zero customer incidents
Are Right, A Lot	B7 · G1 screenshots	B8 · V2 segment rule	5 × 10 passed; concurrency failed; date missed
Learn and Be Curious	B9 · I1 eval set	B10 · S16 security review	$25 → $0.40, 98%; 100% citations
Hire and Develop the Best	B11 · S16 second seat	B12 · V1 signed definitions	Bus factor one → at least two. No direct report.
Insist on the Highest Standards	B13 · G1 date vs standard	B14 · S9 95% ASN gate	Date missed. Or completeness 60% → 95%
Think Big	B15 · V1 graduation criteria	B16 · V2 one rule per segment	7 → 68 (9.7×); $0.66 → $0.03
Bias for Action	B17 · S13 4 AM clears	B18 · V1 same-week hold	99% fill; ~$8M of that day's sales protected
Frugality	B19 · I1 model routing	B20 · S16 priced, not staffed	$25 → $0.40. Or >$100K priced, not saved.
Earn Trust	B21 · G1 owned the miss	B22 · V2 segment change	Date missed, said to the sponsor first
Dive Deep	B23 · S13 scheduler at DST	B24 · S9 spend share	99% fill; ~$8M protected. Or 597 lanes, 80% of spend
Have Backbone, Disagree and Commit	B25 · S14 told the customer	B26 · S9 597 not a thousand	$2.5M order value; $10M initiative won
Deliver Results	B27 · S13 morning surge	B28 · V2 goal changed	99% fill; ~$8M protected. Or 79 customers, $185,892 ARR
Strive to be Earth's Best Employer	B29 · S13 timestamped log	B30 · UDC-B4 analysts	99% / ~$8M. Or reporting workstream in month three
Success and Scale Bring Broad Responsibility	B31 · V1 wave three changed	B32 · S9 small-carrier floor	7 → 68 (9.7×); $0.66 → $0.03

NEW if he leaves the bank: N1 S9 say-no · N2 G1 their test beat mine · N3 I1 independent, never an employer deployment · N4 V1 two quarters of criteria · N5 V2 third-party course change · N6 UDC-B4 the team's 331 / 77 / 36. Three reserve buckets. The gate chain did not hold to a planned day.

E · Bar-raiser trap drills — the sentence to say

I versus we. “I wrote the discrepancy census and the customer pack on the $2.5M order-value break; the consultants traced the handshake and wrote the patch; the customer chose which of the ~200 orders to fix first.” S14

What you would do differently. “I would have written concurrent load, at the customer's user count, into the UAT entrance criteria before five users ever ran the ten scenarios.” G1

A time it failed. “Five users passed ten scenarios, all-user concurrency crashed the system two days before sign-off, I sent screenshots before I reproduced their shape, and the sign-off date was missed.” G1

Who disagreed, and were they right. “My manager wanted the $2.5M discrepancy fixed quietly before the executive review; they were right that the review could not slip, and they were wrong that hiding it was safer than telling the customer with a plan — the customer then awarded the $10M initiative.” S14